

HOW CAN WE BE SECURE IN THE AGE OF TERROR?

“The threat to the public is far greater than ever”

VIKRAM SHARMA



“Intelligence and police must work together”

PETER CLARKE FORMER HEAD,
ANTI-TERROR BRANCH, SCOTLAND YARD

The nature of a threat in the United Kingdom completely changed our concept of how we carried out counter-terrorist operations. We moved to pre-emption.

People feel the UK must have been prepared after 9/11 because it had 30 years of threats from Irish terrorists. However, the nature of the present threat is entirely different. The Irish

threat was essentially domestic. The current threat is a global campaign in origins, reach and ambitions with an object of inflicting mass casualty attacks. We now see suicide as a frequent means of delivering attacks through the Islamic campaign's weaponry and unconventional weaponry in chemical and biological terms. It's difficult to see any negotiable political process. The threat to the public is far greater than anything we have faced in the past.

We took a completely different view on combating this. Now we give ourselves every opportunity to attack the financing of terror, detect hostile reconnaissance, disrupt logistics and intervene in the early stages. Now the intelligence agencies work together from the very